More Than Memories

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/61942492.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Post-Canon, Hurt/Comfort, Nightmares, War Crimes, Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), SPOP Creative Flex (She-Ra), SPOP Flex Secret Solstice (She-Ra)

Language:
English

Stats:
Published: 2025-01-04 Words: 1,713 Chapters: 1/1

More Than Memories

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/61942492.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Post-Canon, Hurt/Comfort, Nightmares, War Crimes, Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), SPOP Creative Flex (She-Ra), SPOP Flex Secret Solstice (She-Ra)

Language:
English

Stats:
Published: 2025-01-04 Words: 1,713 Chapters: 1/1

More Than Memories

by Lisra

Summary

The BFS is on their galactic road trip and things are not as easy as expected!

Notes

Written for the SPOP Flex Secret Solstice for Rea/Døc!

This one was a bit belaboured but I hope I managed to make something out of it. My thanks go as always to my beta Lyssandia.

Check out the other entries in this series, many of the best SPOP writers again participated!

See the end of the work for more notes

The spaceship called Darla traveled silently through the void of space. Three years had passed since the best friend squad had made their impromptu vow to travel through the galaxy at the end of the war. It was now the second month of their journey. Interstellar travel, it turned out, mostly involved killing time.

In the climate controlled sanctuary of their small bedroom, Adora was asleep with Catra curled around her like a living blanket. Catra was limp and was rumbling in her deep sleep as she always did when she was fully relaxed. Adora's mind, however, was somewhere else. It was in a war zone.

Spreading magic across the universe had been easier said than done. Not just because, as Entrapta had put it, space was *just so big*, but because the Galactic Horde had left a galaxy sized mess behind. More than once the raw power of She-Ra had been necessary to clear up something, push something away or pulverize an obstacle. Those tasks were simple enough, if numerous. Some meetings had been *complicated*.

Everyone had hated Prime and his horde of clones, living in fear that soon their usefulness would end and that death of a chip was the next step of the conquest. But many people also hated the First Ones.

The planetary council had been a lot nicer than they needed to be, the friends had agreed later that day, after they had returned from the ninth planet back to Darla. They didn't show much hate for Adora herself, given that the last First One had fallen by the hand of Prime many centuries ago, but the memory of their conquering empire was still vivid. When Adora had transformed into She-Ra, the sight of magic had dispelled the doubts. Prime had hated and hunted magic, and the glowing presence of Melog added to the effect. When the magic of Etheria had flowed through her, an immeasurable amount had been left inside She-Ra. Or perhaps she was now a conduit to the pulsating heart of magic. What was important was that she could give back some of the magic that had vanished. And she had done so, right in the

most magic spot of the planet. She-Ra was a conduit to all the magic of Etheria, a vast and perhaps even infinite amount. But when you plug yourself into a receptacle for magic, you should expect something to happen.

Adora was in a war zone. She saw hordes of mechanical horrors falling from big ships in the sky towards the surface of a planet. Like the creatures commanded by Light Hope they swarmed, driven by the will of a hive mind to subdue any resistance. She saw sorcerers weave runes that caused torrents of blood, which brought fortresses and buildings reaching for the sky crashing down and millions and millions of people in chains. All commanded, planned and executed by people who looked like her. And she was there, again and again, right in the middle of it. Holding a rifle to her shoulder and pulling the trigger, causing a gaping wound in the shape opposite her, too indistinct in the dream to have a face, but screaming in pain. Pushing a button while wearing a finely textured glove covered in runic script and then watching as a weapon from space tore a hole into the surface of a restisting planet. The same gloved hands choking the life out of someone and throwing them to the ground. As the body fell and she looked up, she saw herself, uniformed and covered in blood, looking right back. Something shook her to the ground, stifling her scream.

Adora's eyes flew open, but all she could see were the two spheres of light that were Catra's eyes close to her face. Everything else was dark swirls and confusion.

"Easy, Adora, easy," said the only voice that could reach her through the mess inside her head: the voice of her wife. Catra was gently pushing against her flailing arm.

"You're safe, it's just me with you here, it's - "

"I was there, I was, -" Adora gasped, blinking in a desperate struggle against the dark clouding her vision. A weight settled on her like a warm blanket. Catra was gently holding her down.

“You’re here now, Adora.” her wife soothed, covering as much of Adora with her own body as she could.

Adora stopped trying to speak and instead took a couple of big breaths. Catra purred, as Adora slowly relaxed under her. They lay like this for many minutes. Adora took one breath at a time and Catra purred, giving her space by not asking more questions. Catra knew it was time, when one of Adora’s hands started to pet her neck.

“That bad?” Catra asked, sliding sideways so that she was now plastered against Adora’s side and neck instead of covering her.

“I saw… I think it was the magic. I saw what the First Ones did to this planet. What they must have done to so many others.”

Catra closed her eyes for a moment. She had an idea of what was going through Adora’s head right now. It might need more delicate phrasing than what she was used to.

“Adora…” she began, but Adora wasn’t finished speaking.

“I don’t know anymore. It’s.. it’s weird. When the people got angry on Centaurus 7 I was confused. It was like I was back in Bright Moon just after… leaving the Horde.” Adora’s voice wavered for a moment, struggling as those memories tried to push past the mental debris of the nightmare.

“Everyone was staring back then too. Some Palace Guards even shot at me. But then I understood, they weren’t seeing me, they saw the uniform. And the Centaurians didn’t see me, they saw…. They saw my people.”

Catra didn’t quite manage to suppress a growl. Her purr ceased.

“Adora,” she said, her voice quiet but firm, “they are not your people.”

“But,-”

“You have been born a First One,” Catra admitted, but went on, “whoever your parents and the people around them were, you were brought to Etheria as an infant. You were raised in the Horde, you became a princess, in title and in power. Whatever they did, you had no part in it.”-

Adora sighed.

“It doesn’t feel like that. It’s… it’s like the memories are my own, sort of? Not really memories… They were more like visions. I can’t… I can’t really see them now, but I could see them while asleep as if I had been there.”

She started to shiver as flashes of the atrocities flickered through her mind. Catra pulled her into an embrace this time, surrounding her with as much softness as she had to give.

Gradually, calmed by the strong arms and warm breath of her wife, Adora started to speak, haltingly, hoarsely, recounting some of the things she had seen, the deeds the magic had made her relive.

Catra kept quiet and listened. She wanted to be all there for Adora, but part of her mind was taking it all in and compared notes. She had done bad things. But, it dawned on her, there was a difference. Both of them, Catra and Hordak as leaders of the Horde, were broken people. The strands of fate, circumstance and their own decisions had led them to commit grave deeds. The will to flip the switch and pull the trigger had come from pain and there had been no joy, no reward. And in the end, there had been no excuses either. She had come to regret the blood on her hands and the pain she had caused, most of all to Adora. The First Ones sounded like they had done their murders with a smile and the conviction of being right. Catra wondered if some planets out there had joined Prime in order to fight the First Ones, changing one form of tyranny for another in the end.

It hardly mattered now.

“Thank you for telling me, Adora,” Catra murmured in her ear as she combed through Adora’s hair, “I wish I could take these memories from you. Just… try to remember that you are your own person. Just like… just like how you are She-Ra, yes, but you are not all She-Ras that ever have been… Mara broke with her kind and you finished the job. And now you’re here. Not just another She-Ra. Just Adora. My Adora.”

“You wouldn’t want them,” Adora mumbled into Catra’s fur, blushing at Catra’s words, “This means… everything to me.” No one looked right past the glow of She-Ra as much as Catra, always seeing the girl she grew up with and not the warrior princess. “No one should have…” Catra felt her wife stiffen up as her overwhelmed mind caught up with her mouth.

“I… I wasn’t thinking, my love,” she admitted, hugging Catra back, “and I think I now… understand even more what you went through.”

My memories are not even my own. You have your own to contend with.

Catra placed a kiss on the top of Adora’s head.

“I know, my dear idiot, it’s fine.”

It wasn’t always fine. It probably would never be. But that was a small price to pay. Adora shifted a bit so she could breathe more easily. Her eyes scanned the dark room, until she spotted it. The rings fastened to gold chains were carefully hung on a hook next to the bed and were still new enough that they seemed to gleam in the dark. They had gotten married the week before their departure. Moment by moment the tension drained from her, as she listened to Catra's rumbling breaths.

“Do you think Perfuma does counseling for bad memories that are not my own?” Adora mused, feeling sleepy again.

“Perhaps she’d see it as a challenge. She’d probably say something like *carry the memories but not the guilt* or something”

Catra suggested, “sleep now, Adora? I’ll hold you, now and any day.”

“That sounds like her. Yes, sleep. I love you, Catra.”

“I love you too, my sweet dummy.”

The spaceship known as Darla travelled on, shielding its occupants from the void of space on their mission to spread magic and, against all odds, hope through the galaxy.

End Notes

Thank You for reading. May we all get through this year and may the future be brighter!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!